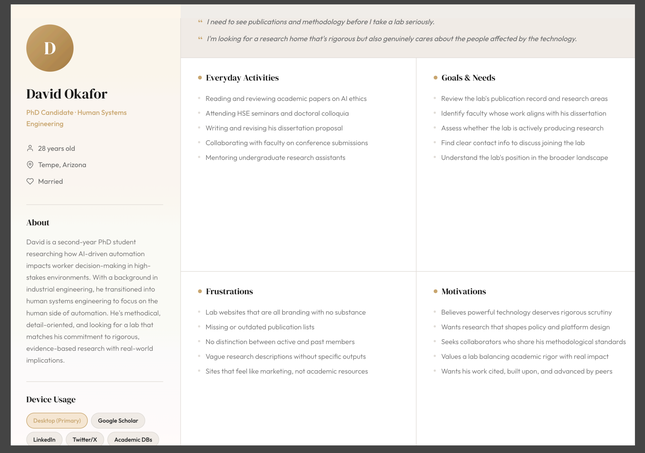
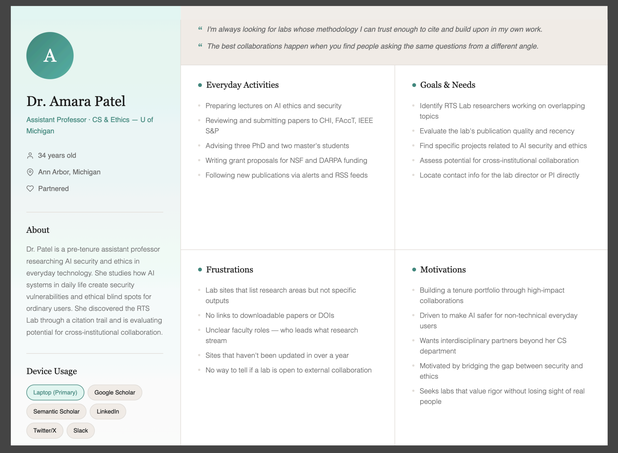
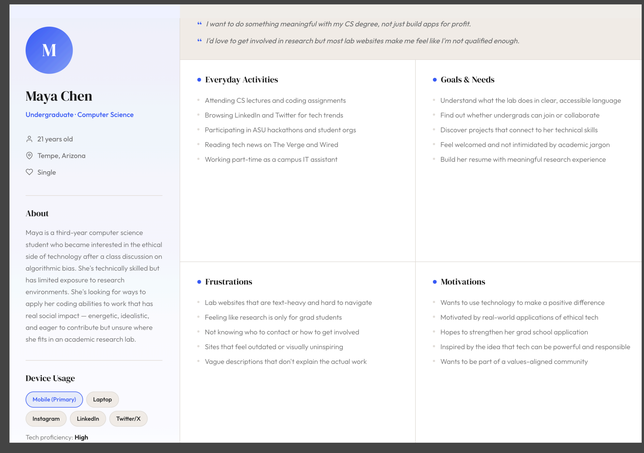

D
David Okafor
PhD Candidate · Human Systems Engineering
28 years old
Tempe, Arizona
Married
About
David is a second-year PhD student researching how AI-driven automation impacts worker decision-making in high-stakes environments. With a background in industrial engineering, he transitioned into human systems engineering to focus on the human side of automation. He's methodical, detail-oriented, and looking for a lab that matches his commitment to rigorous, evidence-based research with real-world implications.
Device Usage
Desktop (Primary)
Google Scholar
LinkedIn
Twitter/X
Academic DBs
"I need to see publications and methodology before I take a lab seriously."
"I'm looking for a research home that's rigorous but also genuinely cares about the people affected by the technology."
Everyday Activities
Reading and reviewing academic papers on AI ethics
Attending HSE seminars and doctoral colloquia
Writing and revising his dissertation proposal
Collaborating with faculty on conference submissions
Mentoring undergraduate research assistants
Goals & Needs
Review the lab's publication record and research areas
Identify faculty whose work aligns with his dissertation
Assess whether the lab is actively producing research
Find clear contact info to discuss joining the lab
Understand the lab's position in the broader landscape
Frustrations
Lab websites that are all branding with no substance
Missing or outdated publication lists
No distinction between active and past members
Vague research descriptions without specific outputs
Sites that feel like marketing, not academic resources
Motivations
Believes powerful technology deserves rigorous scrutiny
Wants research that shapes policy and platform design
Seeks collaborators who share his methodological standards
Values a lab balancing academic rigor with real impact
Wants his work cited, built upon, and advanced by peers


A
Dr. Amara Patel
Assistant Professor · CS & Ethics — U of Michigan
34 years old
Ann Arbor, Michigan
Partnered
About
Dr. Patel is a pre-tenure assistant professor researching AI security and ethics in everyday technology. She studies how AI systems in daily life create security vulnerabilities and ethical blind spots for ordinary users. She discovered the RTS Lab through a citation trail and is evaluating potential for cross-institutional collaboration.
Device Usage
Laptop (Primary)
Google Scholar
Semantic Scholar
LinkedIn
Twitter/X
Slack
"I'm always looking for labs whose methodology I can trust enough to cite and build upon in my own work."
"The best collaborations happen when you find people asking the same questions from a different angle."
Everyday Activities
Preparing lectures on AI ethics and security
Reviewing and submitting papers to CHI, FAccT, IEEE S&P
Advising three PhD and two master's students
Writing grant proposals for NSF and DARPA funding
Following new publications via alerts and RSS feeds
Goals & Needs
Identify RTS Lab researchers working on overlapping topics
Evaluate the lab's publication quality and recency
Find specific projects related to AI security and ethics
Assess potential for cross-institutional collaboration
Locate contact info for the lab director or PI directly
Frustrations
Lab sites that list research areas but not specific outputs
No links to downloadable papers or DOIs
Unclear faculty roles — who leads what research stream
Sites that haven't been updated in over a year
No way to tell if a lab is open to external collaboration
Motivations
Building a tenure portfolio through high-impact collaborations
Driven to make AI safer for non-technical everyday users
Wants interdisciplinary partners beyond her CS department
Motivated by bridging the gap between security and ethics
Seeks labs that value rigor without losing sight of real people


M
Maya Chen
Undergraduate · Computer Science
21 years old
Tempe, Arizona
Single
About
Maya is a third-year computer science student who became interested in the ethical side of technology after a class discussion on algorithmic bias. She's technically skilled but has limited exposure to research environments. She's looking for ways to apply her coding abilities to work that has real social impact — energetic, idealistic, and eager to contribute but unsure where she fits in an academic research lab.
Device Usage
Mobile (Primary)
Laptop
Instagram
LinkedIn
Twitter/X
Tech proficiency: High
"I want to do something meaningful with my CS degree, not just build apps for profit."
"I'd love to get involved in research but most lab websites make me feel like I'm not qualified enough."
Everyday Activities
Attending CS lectures and coding assignments
Browsing LinkedIn and Twitter for tech trends
Participating in ASU hackathons and student orgs
Reading tech news on The Verge and Wired
Working part-time as a campus IT assistant
Goals & Needs
Understand what the lab does in clear, accessible language
Find out whether undergrads can join or collaborate
Discover projects that connect to her technical skills
Feel welcomed and not intimidated by academic jargon
Build her resume with meaningful research experience
Frustrations
Lab websites that are text-heavy and hard to navigate
Feeling like research is only for grad students
Not knowing who to contact or how to get involved
Sites that feel outdated or visually uninspiring
Vague descriptions that don't explain the actual work
Motivations
Wants to use technology to make a positive difference
Motivated by real-world applications of ethical tech
Hopes to strengthen her grad school application
Inspired by the idea that tech can be powerful and responsible
Wants to be part of a values-aligned community